Leila Abbie - Advanced Frontend Web Development

StoryCast Research Document

1. Project summary

StoryCast is a mini website that shares short true stories from Kenya in audio and video. I took the stories from published Kenyan news reports as content. Each story is under four minutes long and comes with captions, a transcript and a list of sources, so every user can watch, listen or read.

The site is accessible and works for everyone, including people who cannot hear the audio, cannot see the screen or cannot use a mouse.

The site has three pages: Home, a Story page and About. Home also shows two more stories as preview cards marked "Coming soon." These cards are placeholders to improve the website's appearance.

2. Audience and user needs

1. Njoki is a 20-year-old Deaf university student who needs accurate captions and a transcript that she can quickly go through as she browses, so every video has captions and every story has a full transcript.

2. Kena is 45, blind, and uses a screen reader with a keyboard. Kena moves around a page by headings and landmarks, so each page has one h1, a clear heading order, and labelled controls. The transcript also describes what is shown on screen.

3. Wendo is 31 and uses a phone on a noisy commute with limited data. Wendo needs readable text, big tap targets and no sound that starts by itself. To accommodate him, the layout stacks into one column on small screens, and there's no autoplay for the audio and videos.

3. Accessibility research

I used the WCAG 2.1 guidelines and the W3C guide on making audio and video accessible. These are the guidelines that matter most for this site:

- Captions and transcripts (1.2.1, 1.2.2): every video gets WebVTT captions through the track element, and every audio story has a text transcript.
- Audio description (1.2.3, 1.2.5): the narration describes what is on screen, and the transcript has the visual details in square brackets.

- Structure (1.3.1): landmarks (header, main, footer), headings in order, and figure with figcaption for media.
- Colour contrast (1.4.3): all text has at least 4.5:1 contrast.
- Resizing and reflow (1.4.4, 1.4.10): sizes use rem, and the layout works in one column at 320 px without sideways scrolling.
- Audio control (1.4.2): nothing autoplays and the native player controls are used.
- Keyboard and focus (2.1.1, 2.4.7): everything can be reached with the keyboard, and the focused item gets a thick outline.
- Skip link (2.4.1): a link at the top of each page jumps to the main content.
- Names and roles (4.1.2): I use native HTML elements first and ARIA only when HTML is not enough, for example aria-current on the active link in the navigation.

4. Content strategy

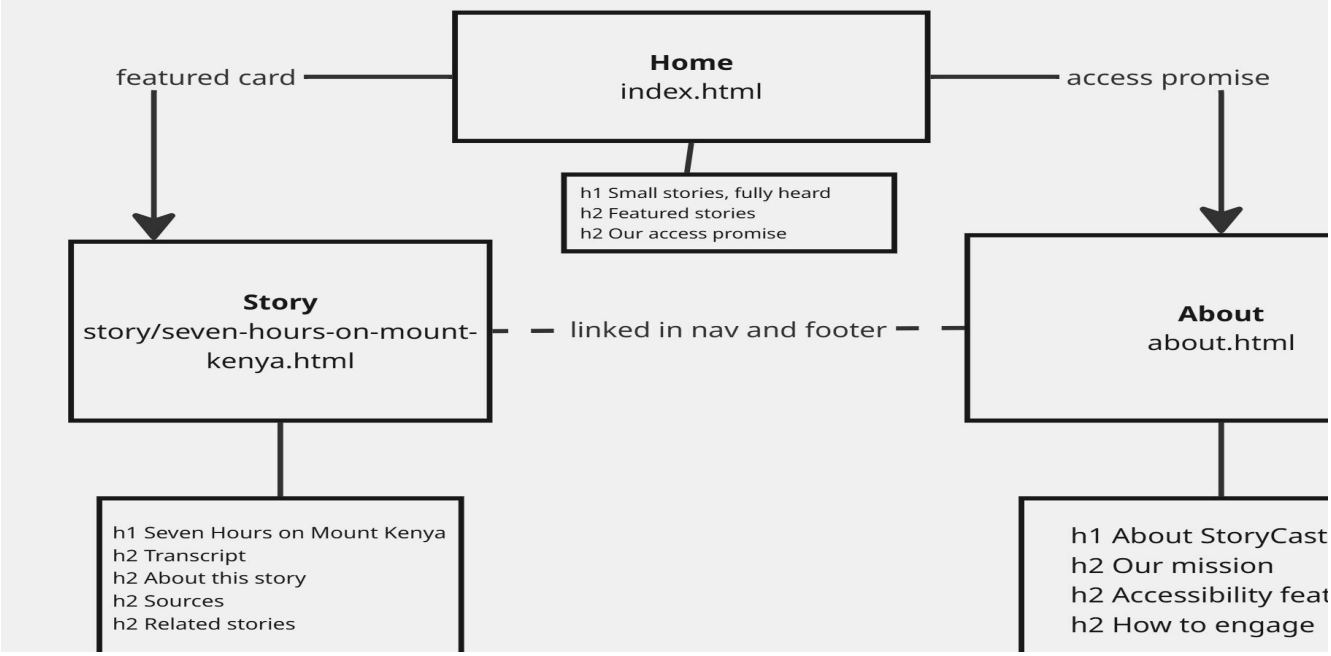
The site has three stories. All three come from published Kenyan reporting, and each shows a different side of life in Kenya.

Seven Hours on Mount Kenya is about Kenneth Kemboi's unsupported run from the Sirimon gate to Point Lenana and back on 20 November 2020. He covered about 49 km in a little over seven hours, reached the summit in 3 hours 45 minutes, ran through knee-deep snow in places and lost the trail for about a kilometer.This is the featured story and it has its own page.

The Clinic That Was Not is about a 31-year-old man in Kayole, Nairobi, who paid more than Sh60,000 for tests and was told he had a liver disorder. A second opinion at Nairobi West Hospital found nothing, and the DCI said the lab reports were fake. A suspect was arrested in April 2024.

The Nairobi Dream is about why young people leave rural areas for the city and what many find there. The Star reports that living in Nairobi costs at least five times more than other parts of Kenya, citing the Kenya National Bureau of Statistics, and an OECD analysis argues that jobs should move closer to the people, instead of the other way round.

5. Sitemap

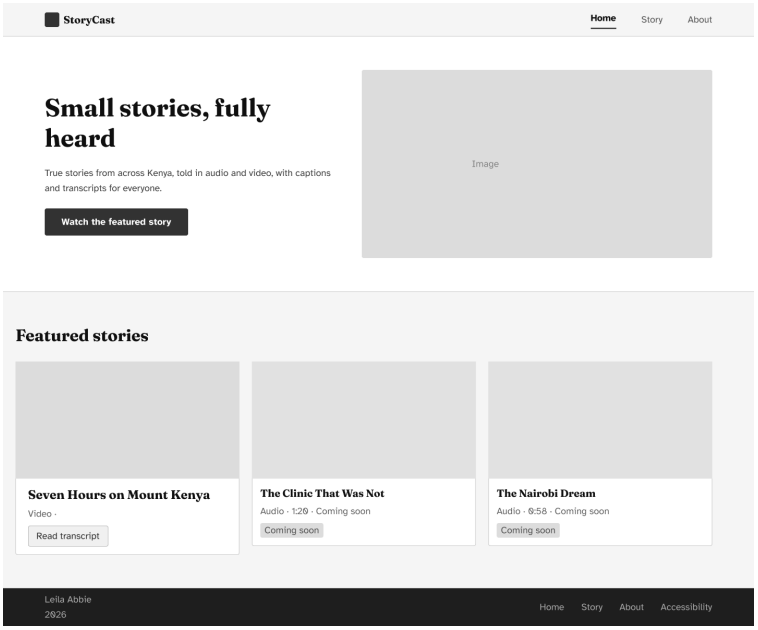


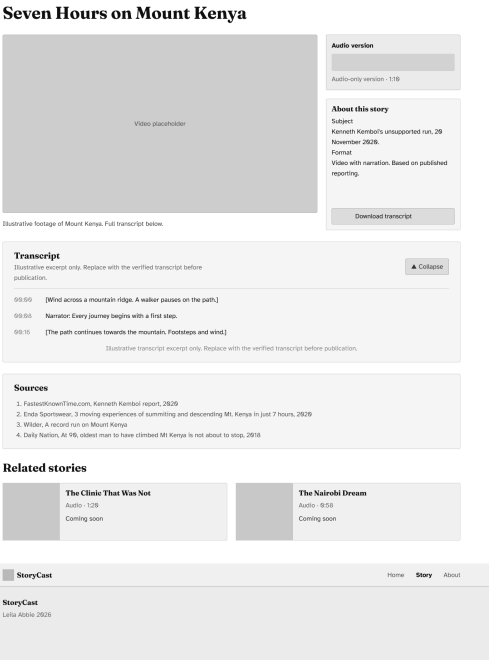
6. Wireframes and high-fidelity mockups

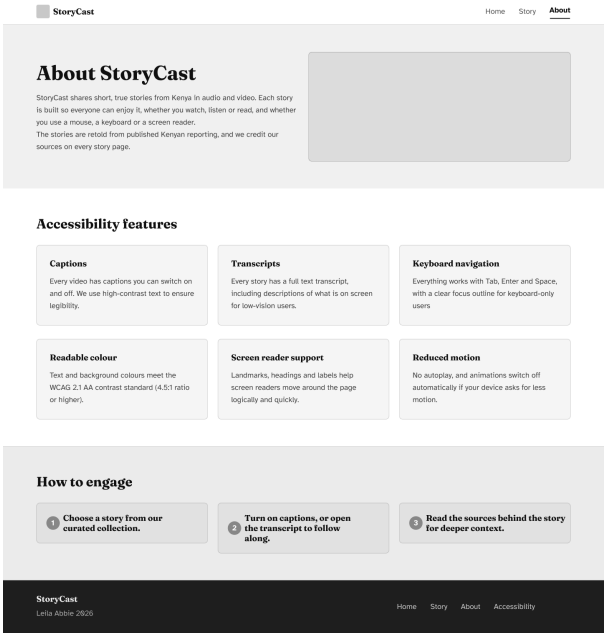
The Wireframes page has simple grey layouts of the home, story and about pages on desktop. The Mockups page has the colour designs of the three pages, with a mobile home page.

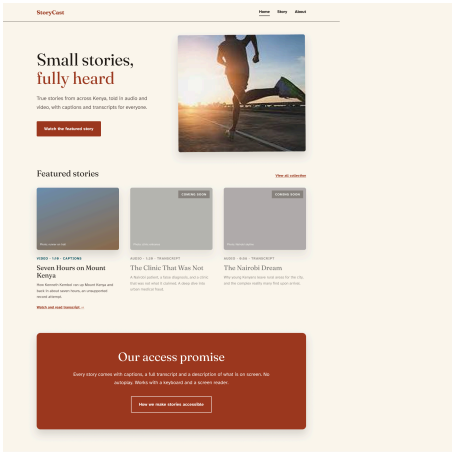
Figma links

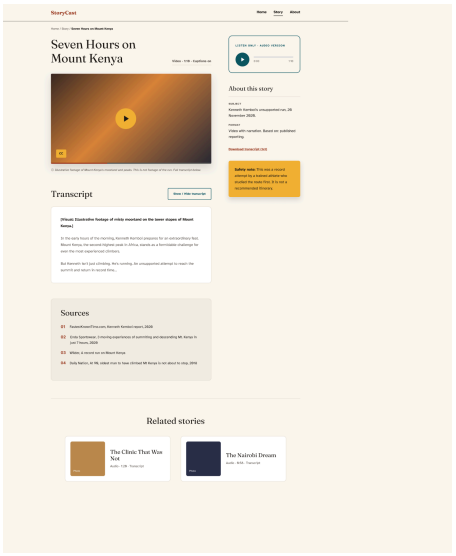
Wireframes:
https://www.figma.com/design/daxLVvN4UG9Ug7IrqgvuUd/Leila-Abbie-Storycast-designs?node-id=0-1&t=QJfewdXkHd9rFH05-1
High-fidelity mockups:
https://www.figma.com/design/daxLVvN4UG9Ug7IrqgvuUd/Leila-Abbie-Storycast-designs?node-id=1-2&t=QJfewdXkHd9rFH05-1

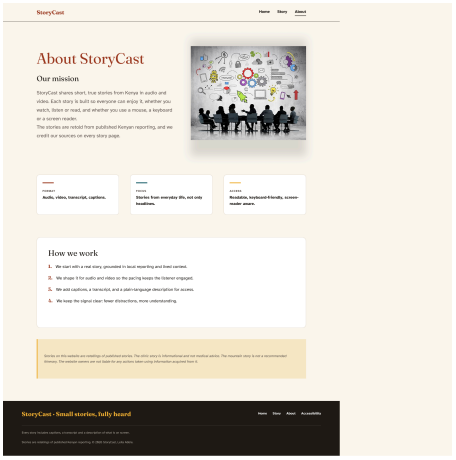

StoryCast
Home
Story
About
Small stories, fully heard
True stories from across Kenya, told in audio and video, with captions and transcripts for everyone.
Watch the featured story
Image
Featured stories
Seven Hours on Mount Kenya
Video ·
Read transcript
The Clinic That Was Not
Audio · 1:28 · Coming soon
Coming soon
The Nairobi Dream
Audio · 9:58 · Coming soon
Coming soon
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2026
Home
Story
About
Accessibility


Seven Hours on Mount Kenya
Video placeholder
Audio version
Audio-only version · 1:18
About this story
Subject
Kenneth Kemboi's unsupported run, 29 November 2026.
Format
Video with narration. Based on published reporting.
Download transcript
Illustrative footage of Mount Kenya. Full transcript below.
Transcript
Illustrative excerpt only. Replace with the verified transcript before publication.
▲ Collapse
00:00 [Wind across a mountain ridge. A walker pauses on the path.]
00:04 Narrator: Every journey begins with a first step.
00:16 [The path continues towards the mountain. Footsteps and wind.]
Illustrative transcript excerpt only. Replace with the verified transcript before publication.
Sources
1. FastestKnownTime.com, Kenneth Kemboi report, 2026
2. Ends Sportswear, 3 moving experiences of summiting and descending Mt. Kenya in just 7 hours, 2026
3. Wilder, A record run on Mount Kenya
4. Daily Nation, At 99, oldest man to have climbed Mt Kenya is not about to stop, 2018
Related stories
The Clinic That Was Not
Audio · 1:28
Coming soon
The Nairobi Dream
Audio · 9:58
Coming soon
StoryCast
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StoryCast
Home
Story
About
About StoryCast
StoryCast shares short, true stories from Kenya in audio and video. Each story is built so everyone can enjoy it, whether you watch, listen or read, and whether you use a mouse, a keyboard or a screen reader.
The stories are retold from published Kenyan reporting, and we credit our sources on every story page.
Accessibility features
Captions
Every video has captions you can switch on and off. We use high-contrast text to ensure legibility.
Transcripts
Every story has a full text transcript, including descriptions of what is on screen for low-vision users.
Keyboard navigation
Everything works with Tab, Enter and Space, with a clear focus outline for keyboard-only users
Readable colour
Text and background colours meet the WCAG 2.1 AA contrast standard (4.5:1 ratio or higher).
Screen reader support
Landmarks, headings and labels help screen readers move around the page logically and quickly.
Reduced motion
No autoplay, and animations switch off automatically if your device asks for less motion.
How to engage
1 Choose a story from our curated collection.
2 Turn on captions, or open the transcript to follow along.
3 Read the sources behind the story for deeper context.
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Home
Story
About
Accessibility









7. References

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https://nairobinews.nation.africa/?p=269168
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https://the-star.co.ke/sasa/lifestyle/2021-08-01-bidding-expensive-kanairo-goodbye
The Star (2020, 20 November). Farms lie idle as youth go to seek casual jobs.
https://www.the-star.co.ke/sasa/lifestyle/2020-11-20-farms-lie-idle-as-youth-go-to-seek-casual-jobs/